

Northfield Analytics Inc.

Employee Handbook — Effective January 2026

1. Introduction

Welcome to Northfield Analytics Inc. This handbook describes the company's core policies covering leave, workplace conduct, remote work, IT equipment, and expense reimbursement. It applies to all full-time and part-time employees across every department. Employees are expected to read this handbook in full during onboarding and to refer back to it whenever questions arise about company policy. Managers are responsible for ensuring their teams understand and follow these guidelines. This handbook is reviewed annually by Human Resources and may be updated as regulations or company practices change; the most current version is always available on the internal HR portal.

2. Leave Policy

2.1 Annual Leave

All full-time employees accrue 20 days of paid annual leave per calendar year, credited at a rate of 1.67 days per completed month of service. Leave requests must be submitted through the HR portal at least 5 business days in advance for planned leave of 3 or more consecutive days. Unused annual leave may be carried over into the following year up to a maximum of 5 days; any balance beyond that is forfeited unless local law requires otherwise. Part-time employees accrue leave on a pro-rated basis according to their contracted hours.

2.2 Sick Leave

Employees are entitled to 10 paid sick days per year. For absences of 3 or more consecutive days, a medical certificate must be submitted to HR within 48 hours of returning to work. Sick leave does not carry over between calendar years. Employees experiencing a long-term illness should contact HR to discuss extended medical leave options, which are handled on a case-by-case basis in accordance with applicable employment law.

2.3 Parental Leave

Primary caregivers are entitled to 16 weeks of paid parental leave, and secondary caregivers to 4 weeks, both of which may begin any time within 12 months of a child's birth or adoption. Employees should notify their manager and HR at least 8 weeks before the intended start date of parental leave to allow time for handover planning.

3. Workplace Conduct

3.1 Code of Conduct

Employees are expected to treat colleagues, clients, and partners with respect and professionalism at all times. Harassment, discrimination, or retaliation of any kind will not be tolerated and should be reported immediately to HR or through the anonymous ethics hotline. Confidential company information, including client data and unreleased financial results, must never be shared outside the organization without prior written authorization.

3.2 Dress Code

Northfield Analytics maintains a business-casual dress code for in-office days. Client-facing meetings, whether in person or virtual, require business attire unless the client has explicitly indicated a casual setting. Department heads may set additional guidance appropriate to their team's work environment.

4. Remote Work Policy

Employees may work remotely up to 3 days per week, subject to manager approval and role suitability. Fully remote arrangements are evaluated individually by HR and the employee's department head. Remote employees must be reachable during core hours of 10:00 AM to 4:00 PM local time and must attend all scheduled meetings with camera on unless otherwise agreed. Employees working remotely are responsible for maintaining a secure and reasonably quiet workspace, and for ensuring their home internet connection meets the minimum bandwidth requirement of 25 Mbps for video conferencing.

Requests for a fully remote arrangement due to relocation must be submitted to HR at least 30 days in advance, as tax and legal considerations vary by jurisdiction and may affect eligibility.

5. IT Equipment Policy

New employees are issued a company laptop, monitor, and peripherals during their first week, coordinated by the IT department. Equipment remains company property and must be returned upon termination of employment or when no longer needed for the role. Employees should never install unauthorized software on company devices; all software requests must go through the IT Service Desk. Lost or stolen equipment must be reported to IT and to a manager within 24 hours so that devices can be remotely locked or wiped.

Employees working remotely who need additional equipment, such as a second monitor or an ergonomic chair, can submit a request through the IT Service Desk portal; approved requests are typically fulfilled within 10 business days.

6. Expense Reimbursement

Business-related expenses such as client travel, meals during business trips, and approved software subscriptions are reimbursable. Employees must submit expense reports through the finance portal within 30 days of incurring the expense, along with itemized receipts. Expenses without a receipt over \$25 will not be reimbursed except in documented exceptional circumstances approved by a department head. Reimbursements are processed within 2 pay cycles of submission.

Per diem rates for domestic travel are \$65 per day for meals and incidentals; international travel per diem rates vary by destination and are published on the finance portal. Alcohol is not reimbursable except for client entertainment, up to a maximum of \$50 per client per event.

7. Contact

Questions about any policy in this handbook should be directed to Human Resources at hr@northfieldanalytics.example or through the HR portal's help desk ticketing system. IT-related questions should go to the IT Service Desk at itsupport@northfieldanalytics.example.